



Ornstein and Smough are a handful for most of us with existing AI, future bosses will massacre us!

the game's bosses can learn and adapt to a player's moveset, forcing players to adapt themselves in order to beat the boss.

In the future, AI will play a much more prominent role in video games. One of the key factors AI will help with content generation within games. Creating the landscapes and the game's world, a world that can react to the player's feedback and decisions taken within the game. Another area AI would help with would be NPC behaviour. As of right now, most NPCs in video games are a complicated tree of many 'if this then that's. Ultimately, all of their reactions and your conversations need to be scripted before hand. As games become more complicated, it will become impossible for developers to factor in every single thing that should affect an NPC's behaviour, which is where AI comes in to save the day. AI could also breathe life into these NPCs, turning them into sophisticated emotional characters, pushing the boundaries of storytelling to a level never seen before. With AI, you might be able to have a true conversation with the NPCs you encounter in a game, without needing a pesky dialogue wheel or options to choose from.

Shifting payment models

As both gaming and us gamers evolve and change, the price we pay to consume games is also likely to change. When cloud gaming becomes mainstream, it's very possible that subscription-based services, akin to

a Netflix for games, will be what's popular. The Xbox Games Pass already proves that this is something that could work, and Microsoft is already planning on implementing the same on their upcoming cloud streaming project. Pay a monthly fee to access a vast library of games that you can immediately try out; sounds pretty good to us. The alternative of course is to buy a personal copy of the game, the way we do now, which might very well be possible 20 years down the line as well, but certainly not as popular.

Game companies will still need to figure out what they can do cover the costs of game development, which is pretty high. In the last 20 years we've seen plenty of ideas that worked, ideas that were hated, and ideas that have pretty much become a standard. Subscription-based games like WoW are still thriving to an extent, the alternative, free-to-play MMOs compensate by either providing a premium paid version of their game

with perks, or offering boosts and cosmetics in an in-game cash shop. Then came the loot boxes and micro-transactions, which honestly, nobody wants, but they work too well for their own good.

GAMING WILL CONTINUE TO CHANGE THE WORLD

Gaming today can rival the best movies when it comes to telling a story. Gaming can be a social movement while also being a form of escapism. Especially during these trying times, gaming was something a lot of people fell back on to regain some normalcy in their lives. Games are creating massive worlds for people to explore, games that are getting closer and closer to looking like reality thanks to improving graphics. Allowing people to experience things they never could have otherwise.

It doesn't stop there though, gaming is also helping bring awareness to issues and provide education. Games like 'Senua's Sacrifice' that brings attention to mental health, or 'That, Dragon, Cancer' which tells the story of a child diagnosed with cancer. Games have been proven to be great English teachers for non-native speakers of the language, and online gaming promotes communication if you want to succeed, an important life skill to have.

Unfortunately, there's still plenty of stigma out there surrounding gaming. Be it simply the thought that gaming is just for kids, or the idea that gaming promotes violence and causes mental disorders. Like with anything in life, every should be enjoyed in moderation, including

gaming. By skipping out, you're going to be missing out on the most interactive and engaging entertainment experiences in existence, experiences that are only going to get increasingly more immersive and impressive in the coming years. 📺

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